

A FIELD GUIDE

The Stupid Simple *Pendant* Guide.

How to turn a 3D printed plastic shell into something that looks, photographs, and reads as brushed aluminum. In ninety minutes. With under fifty dollars.

What we are doing.

01

THE BRIEF

A one paragraph version, in case Jacob needs to explain it to anyone.

We are covering a 3D printed plastic pendant in real silver leaf, which is actual paper-thin metal foil, so the surface looks and photographs like brushed aluminum. The metal goes on with adhesive, gets brushed in one direction with steel wool to create grain, and then gets sealed.

Real metal on the surface means the pendant survives a phone camera zoom. The technique is what museum replica makers and film prop shops use for fake metal that passes close inspection.

TIME REQUIRED

About ninety minutes of hands on work, plus an hour of drying. Total turnaround under three hours.

SKILL REQUIRED

None. Patience, light hands, and the willingness to follow eight numbered steps in order.

TOTAL SPEND

Approximately forty eight dollars Canadian, all in. One stop at Michaels, one stop at Canadian Tire.

END RESULT

A pendant whose outer surface is real metal, brushed in one direction, sealed against tarnish. Reads as brushed aluminum.

"If the investor sees it on a desk, holds it briefly, or photographs it, this passes. Quality matters more than speed."

The *shopping* list.

02

Two stops. Both are at Park Royal in West Vancouver. Allow yourself an hour of round trip plus shopping. Call Michaels first to confirm Saturday hours.

STOP ONE. MICHAELS, PARK ROYAL SHOPPING CENTRE.

2002 Park Royal South, West Vancouver. Phone 604 913 0213. The art and painting aisle. All four items live within ten feet of each other.

NO.	ITEM	WHERE IN STORE	PRICE (CAD)
01	Mona Lisa Imitation Silver Metal Leaf Sheets 5.5 by 5.5 inch sheets. Pack of 25.	Fine art aisle	~ \$16
02	Mona Lisa Metal Leaf Adhesive Size Two ounce bottle. Brush on glue.	Right next to the leaf	~ \$12
03	Mona Lisa Metal Leaf Sealer Spray or brush on, either is fine.	Same shelf	~ \$12
04	Foam Craft Brush One inch wide. Cheapest one available.	Paintbrush aisle	~ \$2
Michaels Subtotal			\$42

STOP TWO. CANADIAN TIRE OR WEST VAN HOME HARDWARE.

Either is fine. Both are within a few minutes of Michaels.

05	0000 Steel Wool Pads Four pack. Any brand. The "0000" grade is the only thing that matters.		~ \$6
Grand Total			~ \$48 CAD

If something is sold out.

03

Every item on the shopping list has a workable backup. None of these will compromise the result. Use them confidently if Michaels has run out.

01

IF NO MONA LISA SILVER LEAF

Buy any product labelled "imitation silver leaf," "silver composition leaf," or "Speedball composition leaf, silver." All are identical for our purposes.

02

IF NO MONA LISA ADHESIVE

Any product labelled "gold leaf size" or "gilding size" works exactly the same way. As a last resort only, school glue thinned with water in a one to one ratio. Use the proper product if at all possible.

03

IF NO MONA LISA SEALER

Any can of clear acrylic spray from the hardware store. Krylon Crystal Clear and Rust Oleum Crystal Clear are both perfect substitutes.

04

IF NO 0000 STEEL WOOL

2000 grit wet sandpaper used very lightly. The result is slightly less authentic but still works. Try every hardware store in West Van before settling for this.

05

IF MICHAELS IS CLOSED ENTIRELY

DeSerres, 1386 Robson Street, downtown Vancouver. Phone 604 687 7733. Saturday hours typically 10 to 6. They carry every product on this list.

Tools you *already* have.

04

Find these around the house before starting. Lay them out next to the work surface. Having everything within arm's reach makes the process feel calm rather than rushed.

-
- The 3D printed pendant (Omar will hand it over)
 - A clean, hard, flat work surface. The kitchen table works. Cover with newspaper or a paper bag first.
 - Paper towels
 - A soft rag or old cotton t-shirt for buffing
 - Disposable gloves, latex or nitrile. Michaels sells these for three dollars if you do not have any at home.
 - A toothpick or bamboo skewer (helpful, not required). It can be pushed gently into one of the pendant's lanyard holes to act as a handle while you work.
 - A timer. Phone is fine.

"Set up your work area first. Open the leaf packet last. The leaf sheets are so thin they will float in any breeze."

A NOTE ON THE WORK ENVIRONMENT

Close any windows. Turn off any fans. Avoid working near a vent. The sheets of metal leaf are roughly half the thickness of a hair and will travel across the room on the slightest air current. A still room is more important than a perfect room.

The *process*, part one.

05

Prep. Ten minutes.

- 01 Put on the gloves. Skin oils are the enemy of clean leaf adhesion.
 - 02 Wash the pendant in warm soapy water. Rinse thoroughly. Dry completely with a paper towel. The surface should feel clean and matte.
 - 03 Place it on the work surface. If you have a toothpick, push it gently into one of the small lanyard holes so the pendant has a stand. Do not force it. The hole only exists to give you a handle for a few minutes.
-

Adhesive. Twenty minutes, mostly waiting.

- 04 Open the Mona Lisa adhesive bottle. Dip the foam brush in. Press the brush against the inside of the bottle to remove excess. You want a thin coat, not a goopy one.
- 05 Brush a thin even coat over the entire pendant. Top, bottom, sides, every face. Do not skip a single surface. Anywhere you miss, the leaf will not stick.
- 06 **THE WAITING STEP**
Set a timer for twenty minutes. Do not touch the pendant. The adhesive starts out milky white and wet. It is ready when it has turned clear AND feels tacky to a knuckle, like a sticky note. Not wet. Not fully dry. Tacky.

The *process*, part two.

06

Apply the leaf. Twenty minutes.

- 07 Open the silver leaf packet carefully. The sheets are unbelievably thin. Breathe gently. Tear off a piece roughly twice the size of the top face of the pendant. Torn or crinkled is fine. Perfect is not the goal.
- 08 Lay the leaf flat onto the pendant. Use the foam brush, dry, to gently press the leaf onto the tacky surface. The leaf will adhere wherever the adhesive is. Press, do not rub. Rubbing tears the leaf.
- 09 Continue adding pieces until the entire pendant is covered. Overlap by a few millimetres at the edges. Overlap lines disappear in the next stage. Bald spots can be patched at any time within twenty four hours, the adhesive stays tacky.
- 10 Once everything is covered, lightly brush away loose excess leaf with the dry foam brush.

Brushed aluminum effect. Ten minutes. The most important step.

- 11 Pull a piece of 0000 steel wool the size of a grape from one of the pads.
- 12 ONE DIRECTION ONLY
Drag the steel wool very lightly across the surface in one direction. For example, top to bottom along the long axis. Never back and forth. About ten gentle passes. The surface will shift from mirror chrome to a softer, directional, brushed look. That is the aluminum effect appearing.
- 13 Repeat on the other faces. Keep the direction consistent on each face. If a face starts to look dull, stop, and buff it back to a soft shine with the cotton rag.

The *process*, part three.

07

Seal. Ten minutes plus drying.

The seal step protects the metal leaf from oxidising, fingerprinting, and rubbing off. Skipping this step means the pendant will tarnish and dull within a few days. Do not skip.

- 14** If the sealer is a spray, shake well, then spray from twelve inches away in light passes. Two or three light passes is better than one heavy one. If the sealer is brush on, use a clean part of the foam brush and apply a thin even coat. Thin, not thick.
- 15** Let dry for at least one hour before handling. Do not put the pendant in a pocket, set it on a textured surface, or apply pressure during this time. Lay it on the toothpick stand or on a piece of waxed paper.

Final checklist before declaring done.

Run through these five questions. If any answer is no, the recovery instructions on page ten will tell you what to do.

- Is the pendant fully covered with leaf, no bald spots visible from any angle?
- Does the surface have a clear directional grain when tilted under light?
- Is the engraved word "Anticipy" still visible and crisp through the leaf?
- Is the sealer fully dry to the touch (60 minutes minimum)?
- When photographed under natural light, does it read as brushed aluminum?

A plan for the day.

08

A reasonable Saturday looks like this. Adjust the start time to suit yourself. Nothing here is on the clock except the adhesive timer in step six.

START	ACTIVITY	DURATION
10:00 AM	Drive to Michaels and Canadian Tire. Buy supplies.	60 min
11:00 AM	Home. Lay out tools. Wash and dry pendant.	15 min
11:15 AM	Brush adhesive onto pendant. Start the twenty minute timer.	20 min
11:35 AM	Apply silver leaf, sheet by sheet.	20 min
11:55 AM	Burnish with steel wool, one direction, light hand.	10 min
12:10 PM	Apply sealer. Set aside undisturbed.	10 min
12:20 PM	Sealer drying. Step away. Make lunch.	60 min
1:20 PM	Pendant ready to handle. Photograph and send to Omar.	Done.

"If something goes wrong, stop. Text Omar a photo. The leaf is reapplied easily. The adhesive remains tacky for twenty four hours."

What it should *look like.*

09

FROM TWO FEET AWAY

Looks like a small brushed aluminum pendant. The grain catches the light gently as it moves.

FROM SIX INCHES

Looks like brushed aluminum with a natural directional grain. Small overlap lines from the leaf application read as authentic finish marks, not flaws.

PHONE CAMERA, ZOOMED IN

Real metal reflection with subtle grain. Because it is real metal.

TO THE TOUCH

Smooth, slightly cool, faintly metallic. Lighter than a real machined block of aluminum, but the visual reads as genuine.

If something goes wrong.

- 01** THE ADHESIVE DRIED FULLY AND IS NO LONGER TACKY
Brush on another thin coat and wait twenty minutes. You can recoat as many times as needed.
- 02** THE LEAF RIPPED WHILE HANDLING
Normal and expected. Torn pieces still adhere. Patch and press.
- 03** THERE ARE BALD SPOTS AFTER APPLYING
Tear another small piece of leaf and press it onto the bald spot. The adhesive is still active for twenty four hours.
- 04** THE STEEL WOOL REMOVED THE LEAF
Too much pressure. Apply more leaf to that spot. The adhesive is still there. Use a lighter hand on the next attempt. Ten gentle passes is the maximum.
- 05** IT LOOKS DULL, NOT SHINY BRUSHED
Over brushed. Buff with the cotton rag to bring shine back. If still dull, apply a fresh patch of leaf on top of the dull section.

For Jacob.

10

This is for an investor meeting early next week. The pendant matters because the investor wants to see the product in physical form. There are two of these to finish: one Small, one Big. Treat the Big one as the practice run. Treat the Small one as the final.

- Take your time. Quality over speed. Ninety minutes is comfortable, not rushed.
- If step seven feels delicate, the pack of twenty five sheets gives you plenty of practice material. Try one piece on a scrap of plastic before touching the pendant.
- Photograph the result in natural daylight when done. Text Omar the photo. He will say if it needs a touch up.
- If anything is unclear, stop and call. Do not improvise on the steel wool step. That is the step that makes or breaks the look.

"Thank you for doing this. The team owes you one."

Anticipy

VIBE YOUR LIFE.

FIELD GUIDE 01
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